

 RELOCATION GUIDE

Hawke's Bay

Te Matau-a-Māui

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Hawke's Bay.

A proper base hospital. Vineyards ten minutes away.

Nau mai, haere mai ki Te Matau-a-Māui. A wide, sunlit crescent of coast on the east of the North Island – two cities twenty minutes apart, a fertile plain between them and hill country behind. It is a region people settle into quickly, and tend to stay.

~180k

people across the region

20 min

between Napier and
Hastings

2,200+

sunshine hours a year

~200 km

of flat, linked cycle trail

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Hawke's Bay

Hawke's Bay makes one of the strongest overall cases of any region we cover, and it is the one we compare most often with the Bay of Plenty.

The bay is shaped like a fish hook, which is what its Māori name describes. Napier sits on the northern arm, rebuilt in Art Deco after the 1931 earthquake. Hastings lies twenty minutes inland across the Heretaunga plain and is home to the region's base hospital. Between and around them: orchards, celebrated vineyards, and ranges rising inland.

Clinical pay is set nationally, so a nurse, radiographer or physiotherapist earns the same in Hastings as in Auckland. What changes is what the money buys – and here it buys a good deal. Housing costs meaningfully less than Tauranga for a comparable sunny, coastal life, commutes are twenty minutes, and the food and wine are extraordinary and, being local, wonderfully good value.



The port at Napier, on the northern arm of the bay.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A base hospital

Real breadth, in a sunny, well-connected region.

A realistic family home

A garden, a good school zone and a short commute on a clinical salary.

The best table in the country

Gimblett Gravels reds, orchard gates and the farmers' market.

GOOD TO KNOW

Tertiary referral

The most complex care goes to Wellington, about four hours away.

Work that matters

Much of the most rewarding work is in communities where your care makes a real difference.

A community that pulled together

Communities rallied after Cyclone Gabrielle in 2023, and recovery continues in a few valleys.

○ Monday to Friday

10–25 MIN

To the hospital depending which city you live in. Flat roads, easy parking, and a genuine option to cycle year-round.

○ After work

Marine Parade in Napier, Te Mata Peak for the view, or a swim. The sea is comfortable from December to April.

○ Saturday

The farmers' market, then a cellar door or a beach. It never gets old.

○ Sunday

A stretch of the cycle trails, the gannets at Cape Kidnappers, or Waimarama and Ocean Beach.

○ Summer

Hot, dry and buzzing — the Art Deco Festival, the wine events, the beaches. A lively few months at the hospital too.

The region at a glance

A wide bay open to the Pacific, a fertile plain behind it, and ranges beyond that strip the westerly of its rain. That geography gives Hawke's Bay its sunshine, its wine and its long, dry summers.

Napier sits on a low hill that was an island until the 1931 earthquake lifted the seabed around it. South across the flat Heretaunga plain lies Hastings, with Havelock North beneath Te Mata Peak. The plain is the productive heart: orchards, vineyards and market gardens on some of the best soil in the country.

West, the land rises through sheep and cattle stations to the Kaweka and Ruahine ranges — the barrier that makes this coast dry. North, the road climbs past the Esk Valley towards Wairoa. South, the coast runs past Cape Kidnappers into Central Hawke's Bay and eventually the Wairarapa.



Hill country behind the plain — the reason this coast is dry.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Around 24–30°C on the plain. Hot and dry; expect summer water restrictions, and a heat pump that cools is a real asset.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 18–24°C. Harvest, and the best of it.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Around 13–16°C. Mild on the coast, with crisp, frosty mornings inland.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 16–22°C. Blossom across the plain, then warm.



About Cyclone Gabrielle

In February 2023 Gabrielle brought catastrophic rain: rivers broke their banks, valleys flooded, roads and bridges were destroyed, thousands were displaced and lives were lost. Napier and Hastings functioned throughout. Recovery in the Esk and Tūtaekurī valleys and on the road north to Wairoa has come a long way, with some still under way. Colleagues here lived through it together, so arrive informed and ask with care.

HAWKE’S BAY

Te Matau-a-Māui

The fish hook of Māui – the shape of the coast.

THE PLAIN

Heretaunga

The plain around Hastings, and the district.

ABOVE HAVELOCK NORTH

Te Mata

The peak, the view and the after-work walk.

NEAR HASTINGS

Gimblett Gravels

A stony sub-region that grows the region’s best reds.

SH5

The Taupō road

Winding and scenic; a lovely drive, taken gently in winter.

HARVEST

RSE workers

Seasonal horticultural workers, many from the Pacific.

Healthcare in Hawke's Bay

A base hospital region with a genuinely wide catchment, a meaningful equity focus, and a rural reach from the East Cape road to the Wairarapa border.

The base hospital sits in Hastings – worth absorbing early, because Napier is the better-known city. It carries acute medicine and surgery, emergency, intensive care, maternity, paediatrics, oncology day services, imaging and a broad outpatient programme for the whole region. Around it are community services in both cities, primary care, iwi and Māori health providers, aged care, and rural services reaching north to Wairoa and south into Central Hawke's Bay.

Complex work – neurosurgery, cardiothoracic surgery, the most complex paediatrics – is referred to Wellington, about four hours away, with Palmerston North closer for some services.

1

base hospital, in Hastings
serving around 180,000
people

~4 hrs

to tertiary referral in
Wellington

~25%

of people identify as Māori

What the work is like

- ✓ Real breadth: as the region's main centre, you see the full range of what comes through the door, and own more of the decisions.
- ✓ Equity at the centre: much of the most meaningful work here is with the communities that need care most.
- ✓ A large rural catchment, with outreach and access work part of many roles.
- ✓ A seasonal workforce: harvest shifts occupational health, primary care demand and interpreting needs.
- ✓ Growing teams and post-cyclone resilience work – real room to make a difference and help shape services.

This is the heartland of Ngāti Kahungunu, the third-largest iwi in the country, and te ao Māori is woven through health delivery rather than added to it – particularly in Wairoa, Flaxmere and the rural districts. Expect karakia at the start of meetings, te reo on the ward and whānau involved in decisions. You can arrive knowing very little te reo; a genuine willingness to learn is warmly welcomed.



Regional practice means knowing your patients and walking alongside them.



A clinician heading in for a shift.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which site, and is there any cross-city or rural outreach working? It shapes where you should live.
- ☐ What is the on-call or rostered-hours pattern, and how is it paid under the relevant collective agreement?
- ☐ What gets referred to Wellington or Palmerston North in my specialty, and how involved do I stay?
- ☐ What orientation, supervision and cultural induction is there for clinicians new to New Zealand?
- ☐ How does the service handle the harvest peak and the summer visitor season?

Where to live in Hawke's Bay

The base hospital is in Hastings, the best-known coastline is in Napier, and they are twenty minutes apart – so plenty of people work in one and live in the other quite happily.

BASE YOURSELF IN NAPIER

The sea in daily life

The hill, the parade and the marina quarter.

Character stock

Hillside villas and the Deco streets rebuilt after 1931.

Worth knowing

An easy, flat twenty minutes across the plain to the hospital.

BASE YOURSELF IN HASTINGS OR HAVELOCK NORTH

Work on the doorstep

Some streets put the hospital inside ten minutes.

The schooling draw

Havelock North's reputation pulls families across the region.

Worth knowing

The beaches are a short, easy drive away.



Central Napier, rebuilt after the 1931 earthquake.



Weatherboard shopfronts and coffee on a Napier street.

NAPIER · VIEWS

Napier Hill & Bluff Hill

The old town on the hill that was once an island. Character houses, steep streets and the best views in town.

NAPIER · WATERFRONT

Ahuriri

The redeveloped marina quarter — apartments and restaurants. Popular with couples and downsizers.

NAPIER SIDE · FAMILIES

Taradale & Greenmeadows

Leafy, established, good schools, and a shorter run to the hospital than central Napier.

NAPIER · ART DECO

Marewa

The Deco residential suburb. Charming streets, well located, increasingly appreciated.

~10 MIN · THE PREMIUM

Havelock North

A village beneath Te Mata Peak with the best schooling reputation in the region.

SHORTEST COMMUTE

Hastings central & Mahora

Walkable, close to the hospital, a mix of character housing and newer infill.

GREAT VALUE

Flaxmere

A close, strong community with regeneration under way, good-value homes — and much of the region's most important health work.

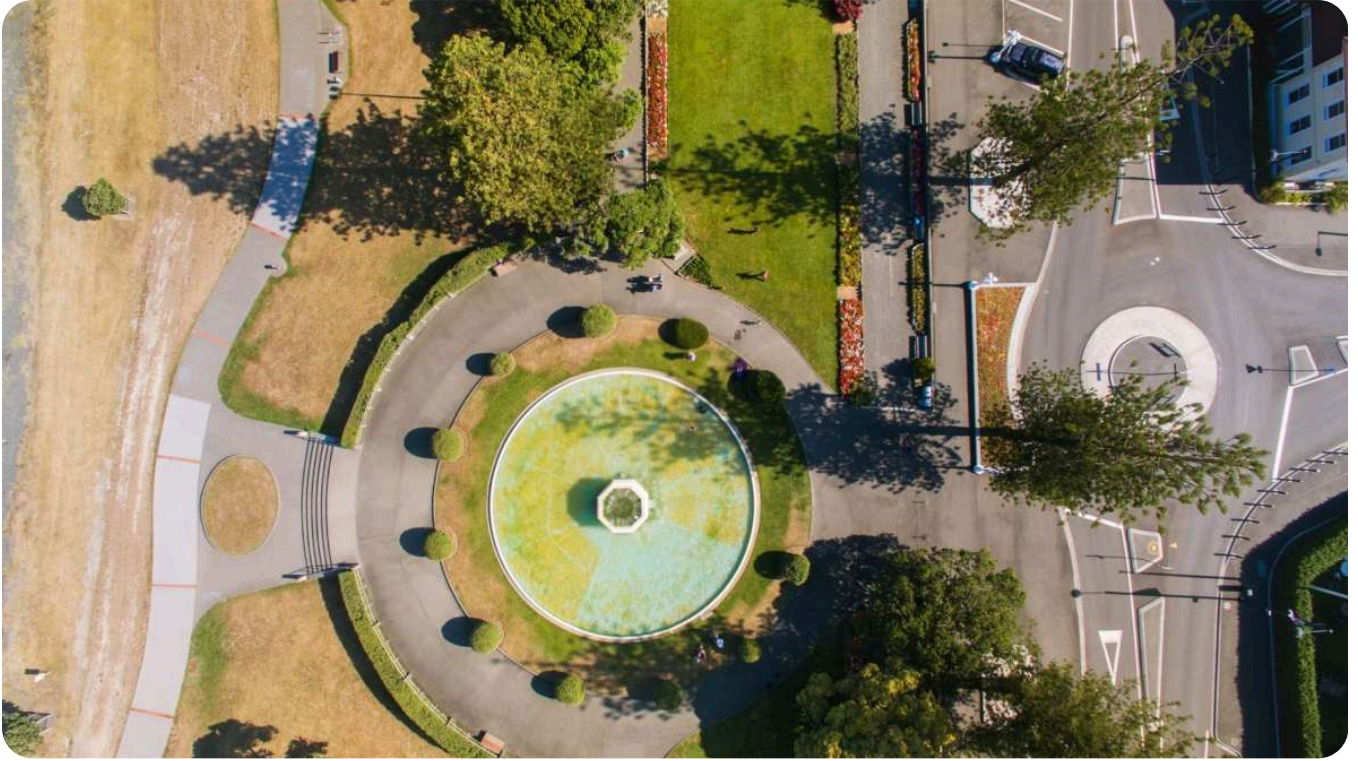
45 MIN SOUTH

Central Hawke's Bay

Waipawa and Waipukurau: country towns with real value and their own rural health service.



Napier's hill: character houses, steep streets and a view over the estuary to the plain.



Napier from above: gardens, fountains and wide, tree-lined streets near the waterfront.

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ Which city, against which work site. Twenty minutes each way is easy; just choose with your roster in mind.
- ☐ Flood exposure and insurance. Ask about the property's history, flood zoning and insurability.
- ☐ The school zone at the exact address. Havelock North and Taradale schools are zoned and in demand.

Getting around

The plain is flat, the cities are twenty minutes apart, and traffic is light. Longer trips – to Wellington, say – are a pleasant drive or a short flight.

Napier to Hastings is about twenty minutes on the expressway, and that route is the spine of the region. Traffic is light, with just a little extra at school-run time. Parking at the hospital and in both centres is straightforward.

The Hawke's Bay Trails are one of New Zealand's Great Rides: around two hundred kilometres of linked, sealed, almost entirely flat path that connects real places – you can commute, shop and reach a cellar door on them. With this climate, cycling to work year-round is genuinely comfortable, and Taradale, Havelock North or central Hastings make ideal bases for it.



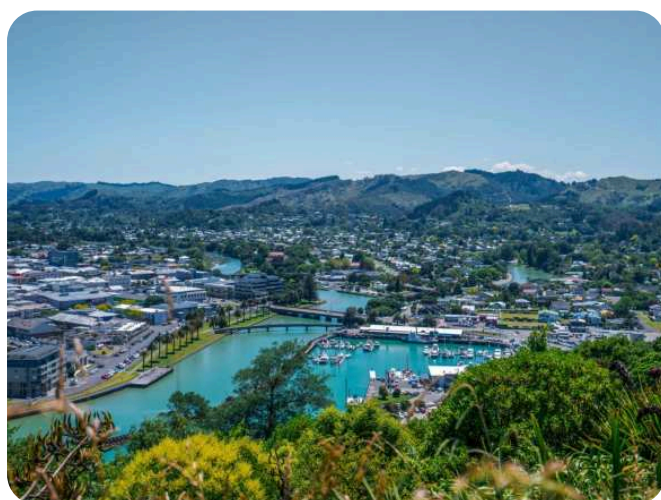
Oak Avenue, near Hastings. The plain is flat, and the back roads make cycling a real option.

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Napier ↔ Hastings	20 min
Hastings → Havelock North	10 min
Napier → airport	10 min

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Hastings → Waimarama or Ocean Beach	30–40 min
Hastings → Waipukurau	45 min
Napier → Taupō	2 hr 15
Hastings → Palmerston North	2 hr 30
Napier → Gisborne	3 hr
Hastings → Wellington	~4 hr

The practical picture

- ✓ Buses link Napier, Hastings, Havelock North and Taradale — useful on main corridors; for shift work most people drive or cycle.
- ✓ A car is handy, and many households who cycle find one is plenty.
- ✓ Napier Airport flies to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch; long-haul goes via Auckland or Wellington.
- ✓ The Taupō road is a scenic drive — take it gently in winter fog and ice, and check the northern route after bad weather.



Gisborne from Titirangi / Kaiti Hill, three to four hours north by road.



Wainui Beach, a Gisborne favourite for surfers and dog walkers.

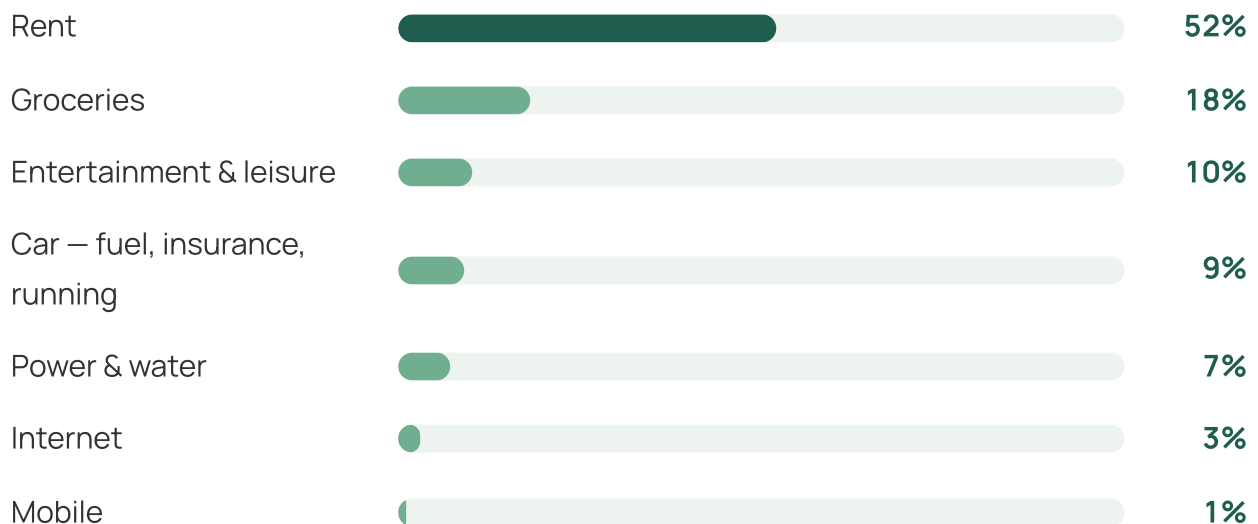
What it costs to live here

If rock-bottom prices are the priority, Palmerston North and Southland edge it. If you want a sunny, coastal, food-and-wine life at a fair price, Hawke's Bay is arguably the best value of all. We no longer print prices, because they go stale; here is the shape instead.

Hawke's Bay offers a real advantage over Tauranga. A family home with a garden, in a good school zone, within twenty-five minutes of the hospital is a realistic purchase on a clinical salary here — noticeably more within reach than the same home in Tauranga.

Within the region there is a clear ladder: Havelock North and the Napier hills at the top; Taradale, Marewa and the settled Hastings suburbs in the middle; Flaxmere and the outer suburbs the most affordable urban options; and Central Hawke's Bay the best value of all.

Where a month goes



proportions, not amounts — one person on a mid-range budget

Costs worth planning for

- ✓ Insurance: check flood zoning, especially in the river valleys, as insurers price it carefully.
- ✓ Dry summers bring water restrictions — sun-loving, hardy plants make for an easy garden.
- ✓ Summer cooling: a heat pump that cools matters as much as one that heats.
- ✓ Living in one city and working in the other adds a little fuel — worth including in the budget.

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A warm, coastal, food-and-wine life for meaningfully less than Tauranga. Check flood zoning when you buy, and the numbers here work well.



Seasonal produce at a weekend market: eating well costs less when you buy what is in season.



Green-lipped mussels, a New Zealand favourite and an affordable treat.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Hawke's Bay

Hawke's Bay is the region I find hardest to argue against. A base hospital, real equity work, two cities twenty minutes apart, and some of the best food and wine in the southern hemisphere – at less than the Bay of Plenty costs.

The two practical things I always raise: the hospital is in Hastings, so choose your city deliberately, and flood zoning is now part of buying a home. Both are an easy afternoon's homework.

The people I place here tend to stay.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Time outdoors together is a big part of why families make the move.



New Zealand bush is never far away, and the walks are made for small legs.

Food, wine and everyday life

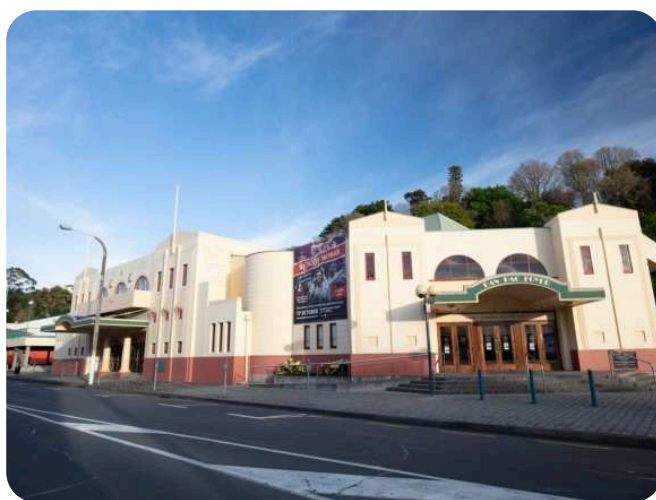
If you care about food, this may be the section that decides it. It is the everyday result of hot summers, good soil and a long history of growing things.

Hawke's Bay is New Zealand's oldest wine region and, for reds, its best: the Gimblett Gravels near Hastings produce syrah and Bordeaux-style blends that stand comparison with anywhere, and the chardonnay is widely held to be the country's finest. The cellar doors are twenty minutes from your house, and Sunday lunch at a vineyard stops being an occasion and becomes a habit.

This is also the fruit bowl of New Zealand — apples, pears, stone fruit, berries and squash at orchard gates. The Hastings farmers' market on a Sunday is, by broad agreement, the best in the country; Napier has its own on Saturdays.



Vines on the plain: the cellar doors are twenty minutes from most homes.



Napier's Art Deco Municipal Theatre.

VILLAGE DINING

Havelock North

Cafés, bakeries and a couple of genuinely serious restaurants, with Te Mata behind.

WATERFRONT AND DECO

Ahuriri & Napier

Good restaurants, wine bars and a strong café scene, buzzing in summer.

EVERYDAY AND DIVERSE

Hastings

Excellent Asian and Pacific food reflecting the city's population.

BOOK IN FEBRUARY

The cellar doors

Several of the region's best restaurants are attached to wineries.

The rhythm of the year

- ✓ Harvest, February to April, is the season that matters: the region fills with pickers and smells of fruit.
- ✓ Sport is the social glue: rugby, netball, cricket, cycling clubs and surf lifesaving.
- ✓ Asian, Indian and Pacific grocers in both cities, and anything very specific can be ordered in.
- ✓ The Art Deco Festival in February books Napier out – vintage cars, period dress, a charming few days.
- ✓ Everyday shopping is well covered, and bigger shopping trips and touring shows make a fun weekend in Wellington or Auckland.



Lunch among the vines: winery restaurants are a Hawke's Bay weekend staple.

Beaches, trails and wine country

A flat plain with two hundred kilometres of trail on it, a peak with the region's best view, surf beaches half an hour east, and ranges behind.

Te Mata Peak rises straight off the plain behind Havelock North. It is about forty minutes on foot, and popular at dawn and dusk. From the summit you get the whole bay, the plain, the ranges and, on a clear day, Ruapehu. Te Mata is also a place of significance in local tradition — the story of the sleeping giant is worth knowing before you climb.



From Te Mata Peak: the hills fall away to the plain, with the bay beyond.

30–40 MIN

Waimarama & Ocean Beach

Proper surf beaches, patrolled in summer, and the weekend default.

~25 MIN FROM NAPIER

Te Awanga & Haumoana

Where vineyards meet the shingle beach. Cellar doors and sea in one afternoon.

LOW TIDE OR BY TOUR

Cape Kidnappers

One of the world's most accessible mainland gannet colonies.

NORTH OF NAPIER

Waipatiki

Small, bush-backed bays that stay peaceful even in January.

AN HOUR OR SO INLAND

Kaweka & Ruahine

Serious tramping country, with huts, tops and true wilderness.

NORTH-WEST OF NAPIER

Boundary Stream

A mainland island sanctuary with some of the best birdsong in the North Island.

What people actually do at the weekend

- ✓ The Hastings Farmers' Market on Sunday morning, or Napier's on Saturday – then coffee in the village.
- ✓ Walk Te Mata Peak at dawn, or the Napier hill and Marine Parade at dusk.
- ✓ Kids' sport on Saturday morning – rugby, netball, football, cricket and surf lifesaving nippers.
- ✓ Bike a loop of the Hawke's Bay Trails, stopping at a cellar door or a café on the way.
- ✓ Swim or surf at Waimarama, Ocean Beach or Westshore.
- ✓ Splash Planet in Hastings and the National Aquarium in Napier for the younger ones.

~200 km

of Great Ride trail
start with the Wineries
loop

2 hr 15

to Taupō and the
volcanoes

3 hr

north to Gisborne and the
East Cape



Pīwakawaka (fantails) are friendly regulars in gardens and on bush tracks across the North Island.



The koru, an unfurling fern frond: in Māori art it stands for new life and new beginnings.

Day trips from Hawke's Bay

Hawke's Bay is well placed for the central North Island. Lake Taupō is about two hours inland, the volcanic mountains and ski fields a little beyond, and Wellington an easy long weekend.

Inland over the ranges, the Napier–Taupō road brings you to Lake Taupō in a little over two hours, and on to Tongariro National Park — the Alpine Crossing in summer, skiing on Mt Ruapehu in winter. North, Lake Tūtira is a peaceful stop for walks and camping, and beyond Wairoa lies Lake Waikaremoana in Te Urewera.

South, Central Hawke's Bay's farm towns and wild coast lead towards Palmerston North and, about four hours away, Wellington — Te Papa, the Zealandia sanctuary and the waterfront. Gisborne and the East Coast are around three hours north.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Westshore, Napier	~5–10 min from Napier	Napier's go-to swimming beach
Waimarama & Ocean Beach	30–40 min from Hastings	The nearest surf beaches — patrolled in summer
Ski fields: Whakapapa & Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu	~3–3.5 hrs	Ruapehu's ski fields make a great winter weekend
Wellington	~4 hrs, or a short flight	The capital: Te Papa, Zealandia, the waterfront
Hawke's Bay Airport, Napier	~10 min from Napier	Domestic flights; long-haul goes via Auckland or Wellington
Palmerston North	~2.5 hrs	The nearest larger city to the south
Te Mata Peak	~10 min from Hastings	The region's best view, and the classic walk
Cape Kidnappers	~30 min, then a walk or tour	The mainland gannet colony
Lake Taupō	~2 hrs 15	The great lake, and the road to the mountains

~2 HRS 15

Lake Taupō

Swimming, boating and trout fishing on New Zealand's largest lake, with Huka Falls just outside town.

~3-3.5 HRS

Tongariro & Ruapehu

The Tongariro Alpine Crossing, volcanic landscapes and the North Island's ski fields.

~40 MIN NORTH

Lake Tūtira

A peaceful lake with easy walks, birdlife and lakeside camping.

~3 HRS

Lake Waikaremoana

A Great Walk around a bush-ringed lake in Te Urewera. Deeply significant country.

~45 MIN-1.5 HRS

Central Hawke's Bay

Country towns, peaceful beaches and the hill near Pōrangahau with the famous long place name.

~4 HRS

Wellington

The capital for a long weekend: Te Papa, Zealandia, the waterfront and a big-city food scene.



A peaceful stretch of the Hawke's Bay coast.



Taupō's boat harbour, where the Waikato River leaves the lake — a little over two hours from Napier.



A family on the gondola at Mt Ruapehu — the nearest ski fields, about three and a half hours away.



Makorori, just north of Gisborne, three to four hours up the coast.



Tongariro National Park, beyond Taupō: the Emerald Lakes on the Tongariro Alpine Crossing.

Growing up in Hawke's Bay

Sunshine, beaches, space, sport, short commutes and a full range of schooling – an easy place to raise children.

Family life here is relaxed and outdoorsy. Commutes are short enough to make the school run and after-school sport, the trails are flat enough for small riders, and summer means beaches and fruit straight from the orchard gate. Splash Planet in Hastings, the National Aquarium on Napier's Marine Parade, playgrounds along the parade and libraries in both cities fill the in-between days.

It is wonderfully international. The health workforce has recruited overseas for years, horticulture brings a substantial Pacific community, and there are established Indian, Filipino and South African networks.

Schools follow the national pattern: free state schools, state-integrated schools (often church schools) and independent schools, including several long-established schools around Havelock North. Popular schools run enrolment zones, so check the exact address before you sign a lease. Large, long-standing secondary options include Napier Boys' and Napier Girls' High Schools, Hastings Boys' and Hastings Girls' High Schools, and Havelock North High School.

For under-fives there are kindergartens, daycares and playcentres in every suburb, and 20 hours of free early childhood education for three- to five-year-olds. EIT, the regional institute of technology, has its main campus in Taradale; for university, Massey in Palmerston North is about two and a half hours away.

Choosing a school from overseas

- ✓ Read any school's Education Review Office (ERO) report at ero.govt.nz – the independent view of how it is doing.
- ✓ Check the enrolment zone against the exact address; Havelock North and Taradale schools are in demand.
- ✓ Ask about state-integrated options if a faith-based school matters to you.
- ✓ Children usually start school on or after their fifth birthday, and must be enrolled by six.



Beach walks after school are an ordinary part of family life in New Zealand.



Evening rides when the days are long.

IT SUITS YOU BEST IF...

- ✓ Your specialty fits a busy base hospital, with tertiary referral to Wellington.
- ✓ You like a relaxed regional pace, with city weekends a short flight away.
- ✓ You want to make a real difference in equity-focused care.
- ✓ You want sunshine, food and wine and an affordable family home in the same move.
- ✓ Comparing options? Palmerston North for housing value; Gisborne for rural autonomy.

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Hawke's Bay suits clinicians who want the good life and a career that grows with them.

Your Hawke's Bay address book

Hastings is the more multicultural of the two cities, with a mosque, two gurdwaras and a large Pacific community, and both Napier and Hastings have Indian and Asian grocers. Organised Malayali, Filipino and South African associations are smaller and harder to find online here than in Tauranga or Palmerston North, so English Language Partners, the councils' welcoming programmes and your new colleagues are the best first contacts.

COUNCILS

Hastings District Council

Rates, rubbish, consents, parks and pools for Hastings, Havelock North and Flaxmere

hastingsdc.govt.nz

Napier City Council

Rates, rubbish, consents, libraries and pools for Napier

napier.govt.nz

Hawke's Bay Regional Council

The regional council: rivers, flood warnings and the goBay bus network

hbrc.govt.nz

Central Hawke's Bay District Council

Council services for Waipukurau, Waipawa and the southern district

chbdc.govt.nz

GETTING OUT AND SETTLING IN

Hawke's Bay NZ

The regional visitor guide: wine, trails, beaches and events

hawkesbaynz.com

NZTA Journey Planner

Live road conditions, including the Napier-Taupō road and SH2 north

journeys.nzta.govt.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with tenancy, employment and everyday questions

cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Settlement information and community connections for new migrants

ethniccommunities.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

English Language Partners Hawke's Bay

Free and low-cost English classes, home tutoring, workplace English and IELTS prep, with classrooms in Napier and Hastings

06 835 7155

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/napier

Hastings District Council – Welcoming Communities

Council programme for newcomers to Hastings and Havelock North

hastingsdc.govt.nz/hastings/community-development/welcoming-communities

Napier City Council – Multicultural Strategy

Napier's plan for newcomers and ethnic communities

napier.govt.nz/napier/about/napiers-multicultural-strategy

Napier City Council – Find a group

Searchable directory of Hawke's Bay community groups and clubs, including cultural groups

napier.govt.nz/napier/find-a-group

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential advice on tenancy, work, money and settling in, with bureaux in Napier and Hastings

cab.org.nz

Hastings District Libraries – Pasifika services

Pacific programmes and resources run through the Hastings libraries

hastingslibraries.co.nz

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

English Language Partners Hawke's Bay

Class terms, conversation groups and enrolment notices

facebook.com/EnglishLanguagePartnersHawkesBay

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Catholic Parish of Napier

St Patrick's (4 Munroe St), St Mary's Taradale (58 Osier Rd) and St Thomas More, Onekawa

06 844 2224 cpon.org.nz

Hastings Catholic Parish

Sacred Heart (425 Heretaunga St E), Our Lady of Lourdes Havelock North (85 Te Mata Rd) and St Peter Chanel, Raureka

06 878 7774 hastingscatholic.org.nz

Anglican Diocese of Waiapu

Based in Napier, with the cathedral and parishes across Napier, Hastings and Havelock North; find a parish here

06 835 8230 waiapuanglicans.org.nz/communities

St Andrew's Presbyterian Church, Hastings

Central Hastings Presbyterian church, Market St South
standrewshastings.org.nz

Equippers Church Hastings

Pentecostal church in Frimley, Hastings

Calvary Baptist Fellowship

Baptist church on Karamu Rd North, Hastings
cbf-hastings.org.nz

Baitul Mokarram Masjid & Islamic Centre

Hawke's Bay's mosque, in Parkvale, Hastings; ask here about halal meat and Eid prayers

Hastings Gurdwara

Gurdwara at 402 Eastbourne St East, Hastings

Gurdwara Shri Guru Ravidass Temple

Second Hastings gurdwara, 193 Havelock North Rd

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Find your nearest meetinghouse in Napier or Hastings
churchofjesuschrist.org/maps/meetinghouses

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Luv Fresh Fruit, Vege & Indian Groceries

Indian groceries and fresh produce, 815 Heretaunga St West, St Leonards, Hastings

SNJ Asian Mart

Asian grocer, 241 Gloucester St, Taradale
06 844 2093

Herbs and Spices

International grocery store, 17B Latham St, Napier South

06 833 6580

Halal and kosher meat

Ask at the Hastings mosque for current halal suppliers. There is no kosher shop in Hawke's Bay, so people order from Wellington or Auckland

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE

Lowest-price chain: Munroe St, Napier South, and Heretaunga St West, Hastings
paknsave.co.nz

New World

Onekawa and Greenmeadows in Napier, central Hastings and Havelock North
newworld.co.nz

Woolworths

Supermarket chain with a store in Marewa, Napier; use the store finder for the rest of the Bay
woolworths.co.nz

Four Square

Neighbourhood stores in Ahuriri, Marewa, Frimley, Mahora and elsewhere

foursquare.co.nz

Hawke's Bay Farmers' Market, Hastings

Sundays 8:30am–12:30pm at Waikoko Gardens, Tōmoana Showgrounds; often called the best in the country

hawkesbayfarmersmarket.co.nz

Napier Urban Farmers' Market

Saturdays 8:30am–12:30pm, Clive Square, central Napier; on a temporary site until November 2026, so check the website

hawkesbayfarmersmarket.co.nz

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts – find a school

Search schools and check enrolment zones by address

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

NZ Uniforms

School uniform stockist with a Hastings store; also check your school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales

nzuniforms.com

Plunket

Free Well Child checks and parenting support for under-5s; register when you arrive

plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood centres; a good way for parents to meet people

playcentre.org.nz

Hastings District Libraries

Hastings, Havelock North and Flaxmere: Rhythm and Rhymes for toddlers, Play Learn Connect and teen activities

hastingslibraries.co.nz

Napier Libraries

Free membership, books, e-books and children's sessions

napier.govt.nz/napier/facilities/napier-libraries

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me – Napier rentals

The main place rentals are advertised

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/hawkes-bay/napier

Trade Me – Hastings rentals

Rental listings for Hastings, Havelock North and Flaxmere

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/hawkes-bay/hastings

realestate.co.nz – Hawke's Bay

Homes for sale across Napier and the region

realestate.co.nz/residential/sale/hawkes-bay

realestate.co.nz – Hastings

Homes for sale in Hastings and Havelock North

realestate.co.nz/residential/sale/hawkes-bay/hastings

Tenancy Services – market rent

Check typical rents for a suburb and house size before you apply

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Napier City Council – rates

Look up the rates on a Napier property

napier.govt.nz/services/properties-and-rates/rates

Hastings District Council – rates

Look up the rates on a Hastings or Havelock North property

hastingsdc.govt.nz/services/properties-and-rates/rates

Trade Me – flatmates wanted

Rooms and flatshares if you are coming ahead of your family

trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

goBay

Bus network for Napier, Taradale, Hastings, Flaxmere and Havelock North; routes and timetables

gobay.co.nz

Bee Card

Fare card for goBay buses, also used in the Bay of Plenty and Waikato; top up online

beecard.co.nz

Hawke's Bay Airport

Napier airport, about ten minutes from the city; domestic flights, with international travel via Auckland or Wellington

hawkesbay-airport.co.nz

InterCity

Long-distance coaches from Napier and Hastings to Wellington, Palmerston North, Taupō and Auckland

intercity.co.nz

NZTA – driver licensing

Converting an overseas licence and finding a licensing agent

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

AA

Licence conversions, tests and vehicle checks at AA centres

aa.co.nz

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo – Napier

User-reported cost of living for Napier (small sample), comparable with your home city

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Napier

Tenancy Services – market rent

Official median rents by suburb from bond data

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Stats NZ

Official figures on prices, wages and household spending

stats.govt.nz

Powerswitch

Compare power and broadband plans for your address

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free budgeting tools for your first months

sorted.org.nz

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

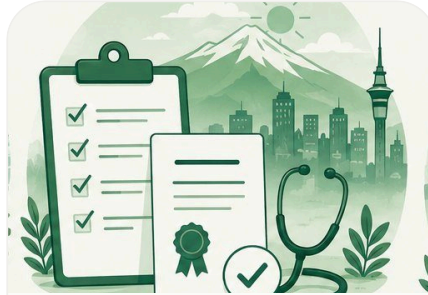
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

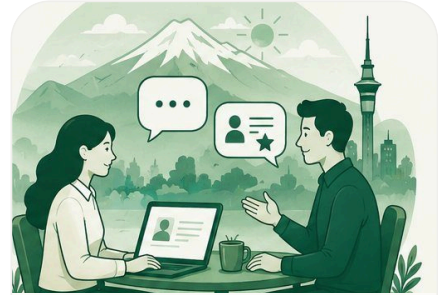
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

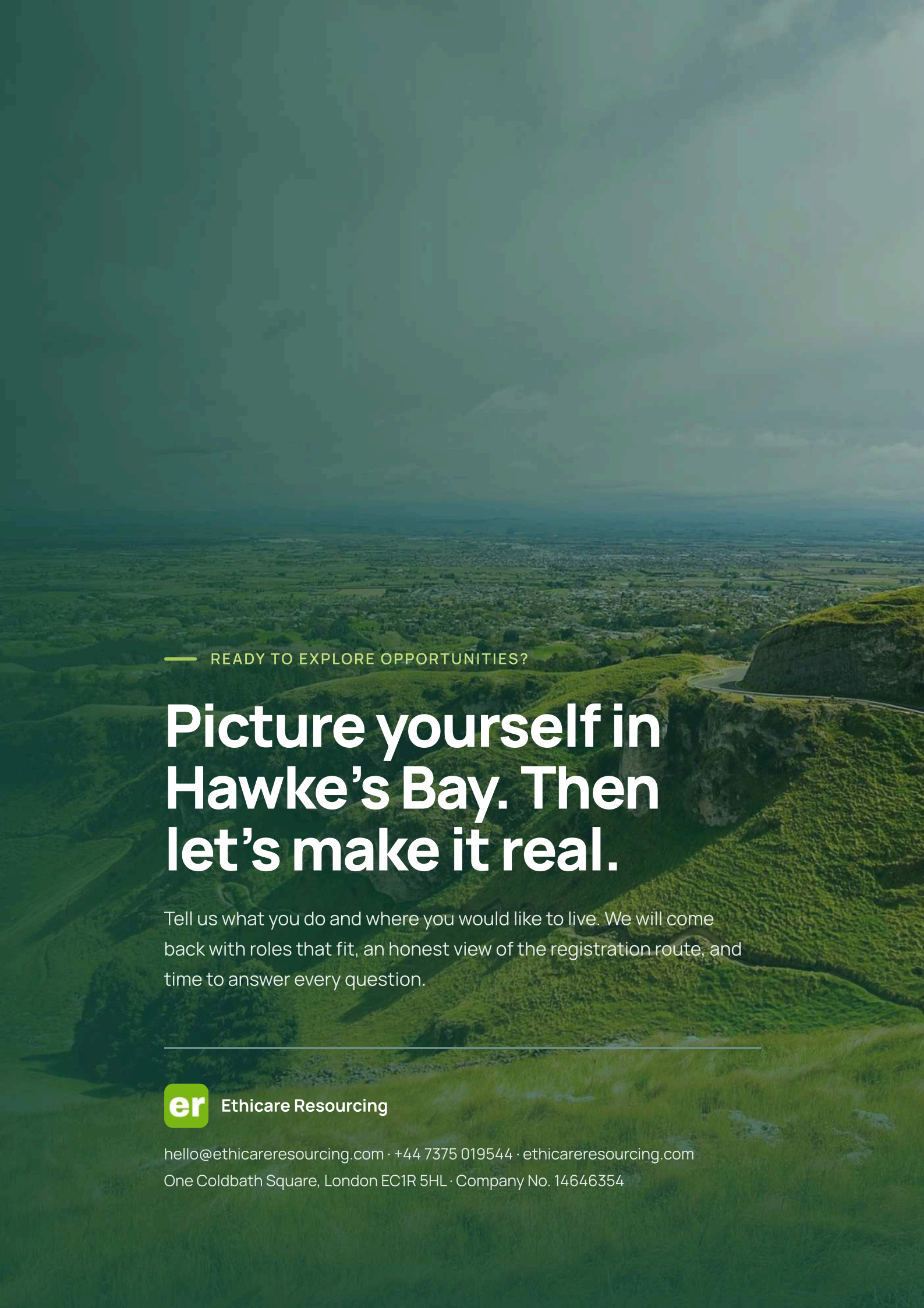
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Hawke's Bay. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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